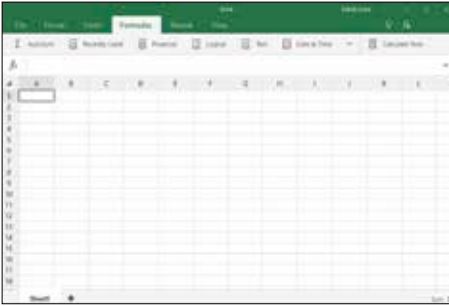




The Microsoft Excel for phones is a UWA that can run on mobile and desktop.

that just uses the functionality presented by the Universal Windows Platform can run on all Windows 10 devices, even those that haven't been invented yet.

On top of this core Microsoft can extend the Windows experience based on the 'device family'. For instance, embedded devices such as

Raspberry Pi need bare minimum functionality, then come Mobile devices that need support for bluetooth, NFC etc. Then you have the PC family that includes tablets and convertibles that run the traditional Windows desktop UI experience and provide the traditional Win32 API as well. You also have the Surface Hub, Microsoft's large 55-inch and above multi-touch interactive whiteboard solution for enterprises, that has its own set of features that developers can use. Also soon you will have the HoloLens, which too will run Windows 10 while providing a completely different experience.

This allows application developers to create applications that can run on any Windows device while using the same codebase, and in some cases even the same binary. If an application uses only the features available in the Windows Core, then it will simply run on all devices since they all include the Windows Core. If it uses features present only in one platform, it can detect those features at runtime and adapt its functionality and interface accordingly. Even for the UI, Microsoft has some support for adaptive interfaces which will let developers create interfaces that can run on all devices, from a 5-inch mobile to a 55-inch surface hub.

Let's look at some of these new entrants to the Windows ecosystem.

Windows 10 for IoT

For those hardware tinkerers with Raspberry Pis and other similar devices, Microsoft has released a new edition of Windows that can run on those devices. What's more, Microsoft has made this edition available for free to play around with.

This edition of Windows is probably closest to the Windows 10 core, as it features no desktop mode, or even a CLI. You can however write applica-